Community Statement

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SIP405: Student Innovation Project II

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July 19, 2026

Community Statement

Part 1: Person

I want to take a second for you to get to know me. I am a 19 year old African American woman who loves playing the piano, baking, and hanging out with my family and friends. I love watching my family and chosen family succeed in life, and I want to carry this happiness to others. As a member of the National Society of High School Scholars, I took a pledge to strive for excellence in my academic endeavors, and to use my knowledge and wisdom to the best of my ability for the betterment of the global community.

When I was young, I struggled with a few of my own health issues. I couldn't play tag with other kids at recess, I couldn't participate in P.E. (although 10-year-old me was pretty happy about that), and I often spent time in the hospital getting breathing treatments for my severe asthma. The machine that helped me through my health issues was the nebulizer. This machine helped me breathe when my lungs refused to. According to the CDC, 3,517 people die from asthma each year (*Most recent national asthma data,* 2023). This number would be a lot higher if it weren't for the research that went into developing inhalers, nebulizers, and other breathing treatments. Watching how these medical professionals took care of me, influenced me to follow a similar path. I want to be on a team that gathers the knowledge that helps create the medicine, treatments, and technology that saves someone's life.

Part 2: Community

Because of my own experience with health issues growing up, I know how stressful it can be to be ill as a child, and the toll it takes on the parents and siblings of that child. Children with

compromised immune systems or extreme health issues often spend the majority of their time in quarantine, and siblings of these children also become isolated for the fear of bringing home something that could harm their sick sibling. This past year I have been involved in my community by volunteering at Lily's Pad in Tempe, AZ. They are an indoor playground for children with immunocompromised conditions. I typically worked with a team of fellow volunteers to keep the playground sanitary so that these children can play in a safe environment. This effort helped these children be able to live a worry-free life for at least a few hours.

My professional goal after graduation is to work in Femtech. A corner of healthcare dedicated to the research and development of products for health conditions specific to women. Clue, an app that I personally use, provides a menstrual and reproductive health tracking app for women. Elvie, another Femtech company, is dedicated to innovating and revolutionizing wearable tech for women, and changing attitudes towards breast pumping, pelvic floor training, and post-partum health. I also want to develop medical technology as I come from a family of medical professionals; my grandma was a nurse, and my mom is an Emergency Medical Technician who is studying to become a nurse. I want to develop systems to make their jobs easier and to improve their patients' quality of care. I've always been raised in an environment of healthy eating, and taking care of others and the community, and I want to go into a career that supports these values.

Part 3: Conclusion

This past year, I have studied different scripting languages to be able to create platforms and softwares with the goal of being able to expand access to healthcare. As exemplified during Covid, there is a need for virtual health tools like virtual doctor appointments. To reach these

goals, I learned Python to process and analyze data, and have studied data analysis, regression, and data structures and algorithms. I have spent my time learning coding languages like C#, C++, Java, and HTML, to create a variety of different applications compatible with different platforms and devices. And I have been actively strengthening my problem solving and agile software development skills by building projects and theoretical systems to fulfill these purposes. In all, I feel like my personal, professional, and community experiences have shaped me into a well-rounded person who is ready to address the problems in my community.